GRAIN · GLOBAL RESILIENT ANTICIPATORY INFRASTRUCTURE NETWORK

Trade that holds when *a link breaks.*

If one chokepoint fails, through error, conflict or capture, the whole global economy feels it. GRAIN maps the nodes that keep critical goods flowing under extreme stress, and finds where resilience and economic incentives already point the same way.

Read the 2025 GRAIN report

Policy brief, Feb 2026

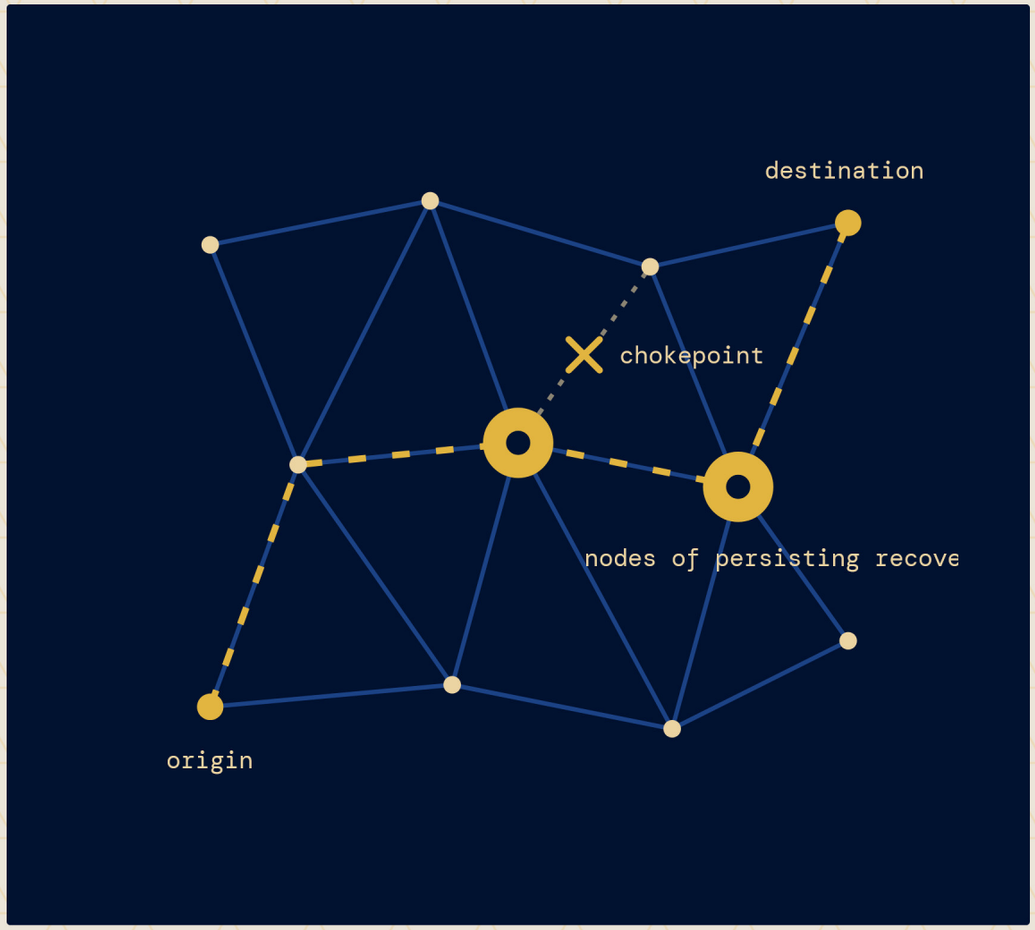


Fig. 1 — A resilient trade network. Sever one chokepoint and the flow reroutes through nodes of persisting recovery. GRAIN identifies where those nodes are.

01 — Map

Monitoring chokepoints

Tracking critical material vulnerabilities, from fuel and fertiliser to helium, before they cascade.

02 — Secure

Protecting core commodities

Using Revealed Comparative Advantage to find trusted, distributed sources of food, energy and medicine.

03 — Build

Strengthening institutions

Adaptive governance playbooks that keep nations operating through global catastrophic events.

01 / 03

Look further. *Decide together.*

We chart a democratic course to resilience and flourishing, blending foresight, expert insight and citizen deliberation.

What we focus on

All focus areas →

Institutions

Palaeolithic emotions, mediaeval institutions, godlike technology.

Wellbeing

Fostering human flourishing, beyond mere survival.

Rethinking economics and long-term planning

Resilience

Reinforcing the places where resilience is needed most.

All-hazards, not one at a time

ODYSSEAN INSTITUTE

PILOT HORIZON SCAN · GLOBAL CATASTROPHIC RISKS

Five signals worth *watching closely.*



Each track is an emerging issue identified by the experts we surveyed. Select one to follow its path.

01 [Key issue title 01]

02 [Key issue title 02]

03 [Key issue title 03]

04 [Key issue title 04]

05 [Key issue title 05]

Signal 01 · [time horizon]

[Key issue title 01]

[Two-sentence summary of this issue from the Horizon Scan: what is changing, and why it matters for decision-makers.]

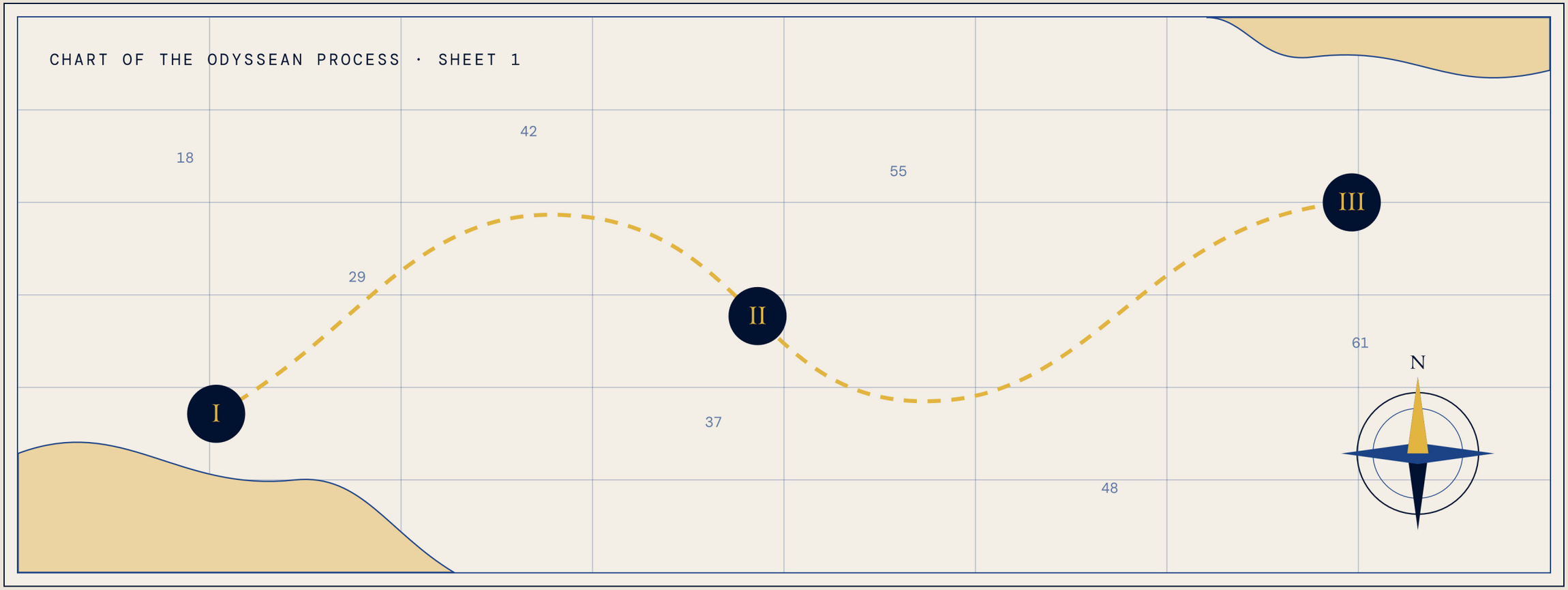
Read the full Horizon Scan →

ODYSSEAN INSTITUTE

OUR METHOD · THE ODYSSEAN PROCESS

How the voyage *is charted.*

Three ports of call take us from expert knowledge to democratic decisions, each one building on the last.



Port I

Sample

We survey scientists and specialists to surface the emerging trends that matter most.

Port II

Map

We model the systems behind those trends and simulate the range of futures they could lead to.

Port III

Empower

We equip citizens' assemblies with these tools, so their recommendations rest on the best evidence.

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Projects

Room 1 — Current work 3 panels Archive →

1

Resilience Report published

GRAIN

Mapping the countries and industries that keep fertiliser, energy and staple foods flowing in a crisis, so trade holds when a chokepoint breaks.

2

Foresight Published 2024

Horizon Scan on Global Catastrophic Risks

Experts scored the catastrophic risks we are least prepared for, from cascading food-system failures to AI in nuclear weapons systems.

3

Deliberation Live · Assembly Nov 2026

The Odyssean Process on AI

The first full run of our Process: 29 experts scored 60+ AI risks and solutions, feeding scenario modelling and a UK citizens' assembly in Manchester.

RESEARCH & ANALYSIS

Publications

FILTER BY TYPE

All publications

Policy briefs

White papers

Research reports

Blog & commentary

Curriculum



FEATURED · WHITE PAPER

Charting a democratic course to resilience and flourishing

How effective democratic deliberation, enriched by science and expert insight, can improve institutional decision-making on the grand challenges we face.

Read the White Paper PDF · [Month Year]

RESEARCH REPORT

Horizon Scan on Global Catastrophic Risks

[Authors] · [Month Year]

POLICY BRIEF

[Policy Brief title]

[Authors] · [Month Year]

COMMENTARY

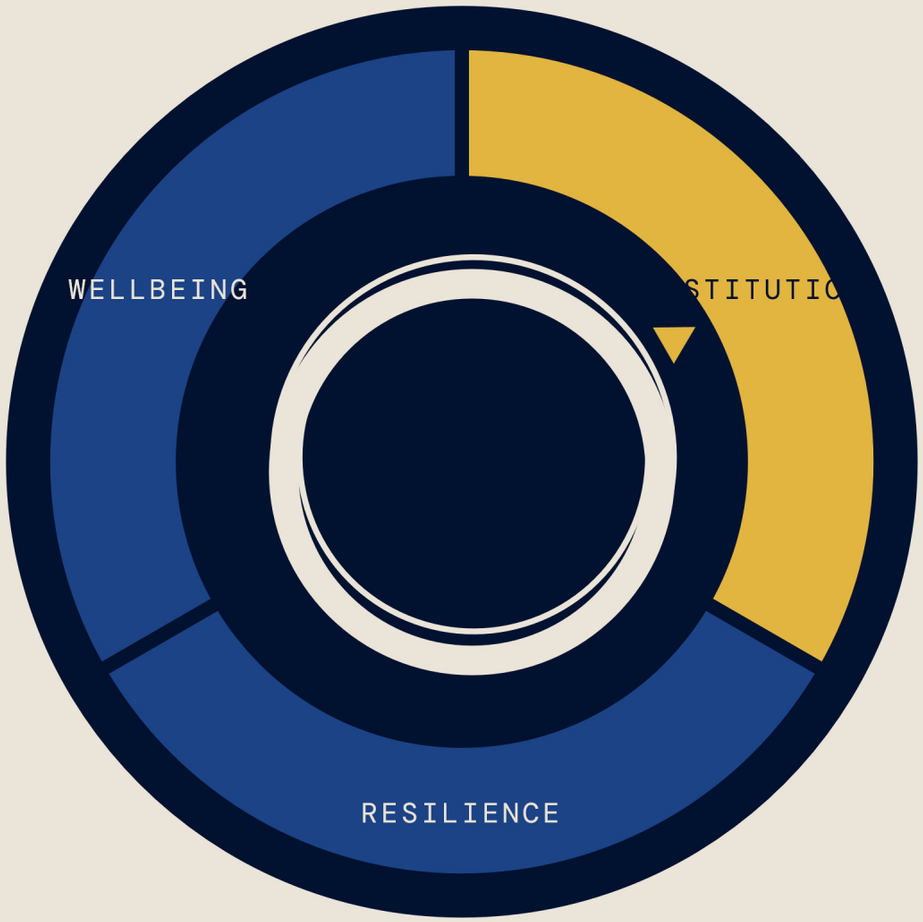
[Blog post title]

[Author] · [Month Year]

ODYSSEAN INSTITUTE

HOMEPAGE · FOCUS AREAS

Our mark, *three ways in.*



Institutions | Resilience | Wellbeing

Institutions

Empowering people and institutions to navigate complex problems in times of crisis, blending computational foresight and expert knowledge with participatory decision-making.

> *We have Palaeolithic emotions, mediaeval institutions and godlike technology.*
>
> E.O. Wilson

Explore Institutions →

The same mark at every scale

Favicon

Loader

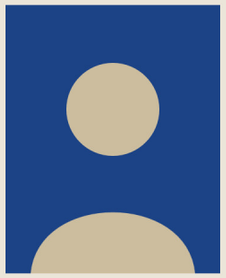
Section marker

ODYSSEAN INSTITUTE Footer lockup

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THE WISDOM OF THE CROWD, INFORMED

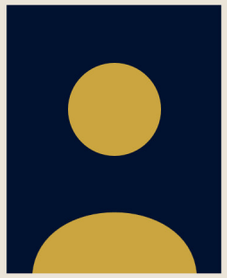
Expertise, meet *lived experience.*



THE EXPERT

"[Quote from a scientist in the Horizon Scan on what the evidence shows.]"

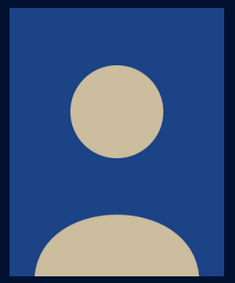
[Name], [Discipline / institution]



THE CITIZEN

"[Quote from an assembly member on what that evidence means for their life.]"

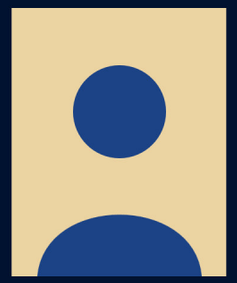
[First name], assembly member, [Town]



THE CITIZEN

"[A question an assembly member put to the experts.]"

[First name], AI Governance Assembly



THE EXPERT

"[The expert's answer, and what they learned from being asked.]"

[Name], [Discipline / institution]

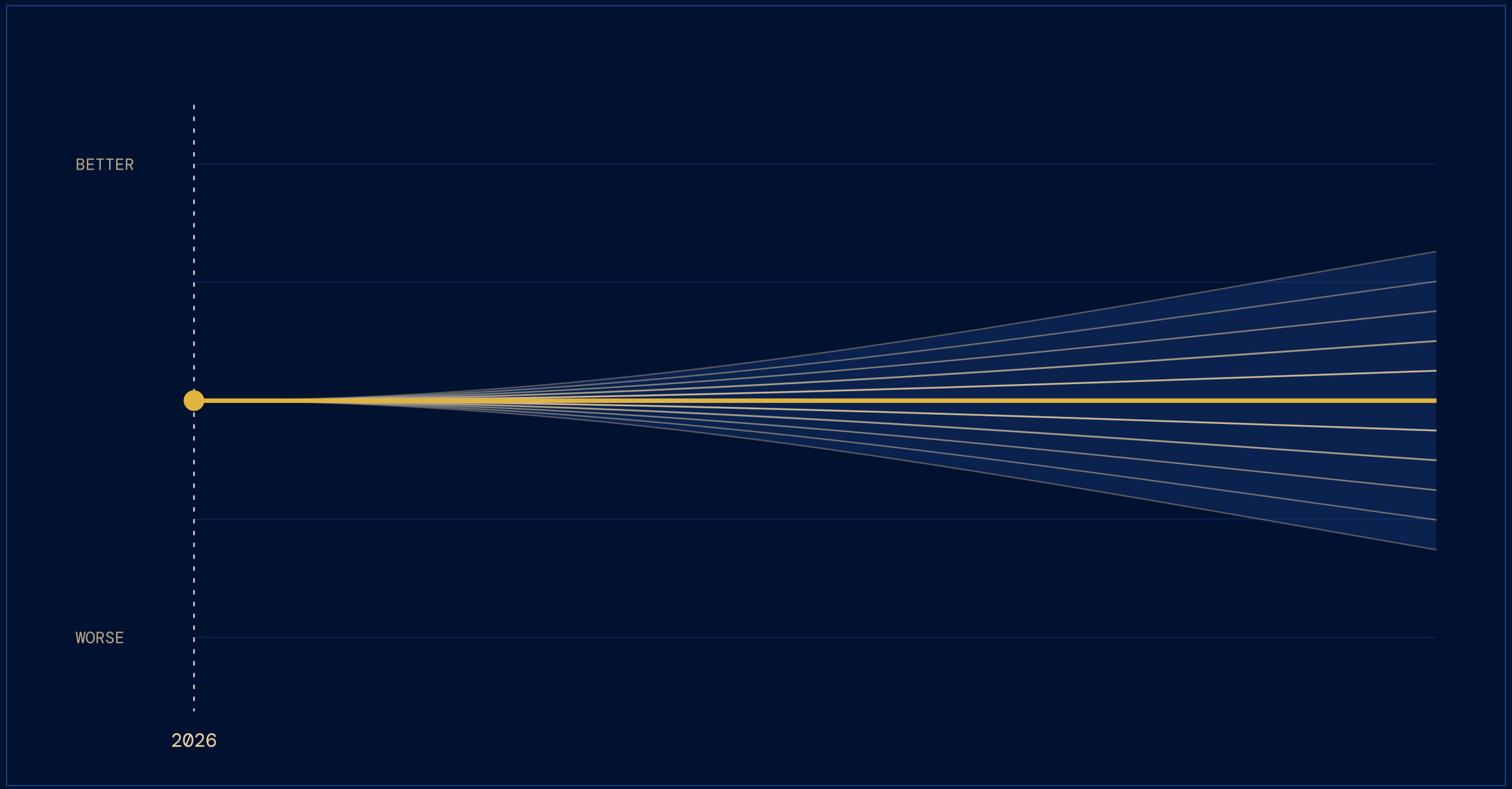
How our assemblies work

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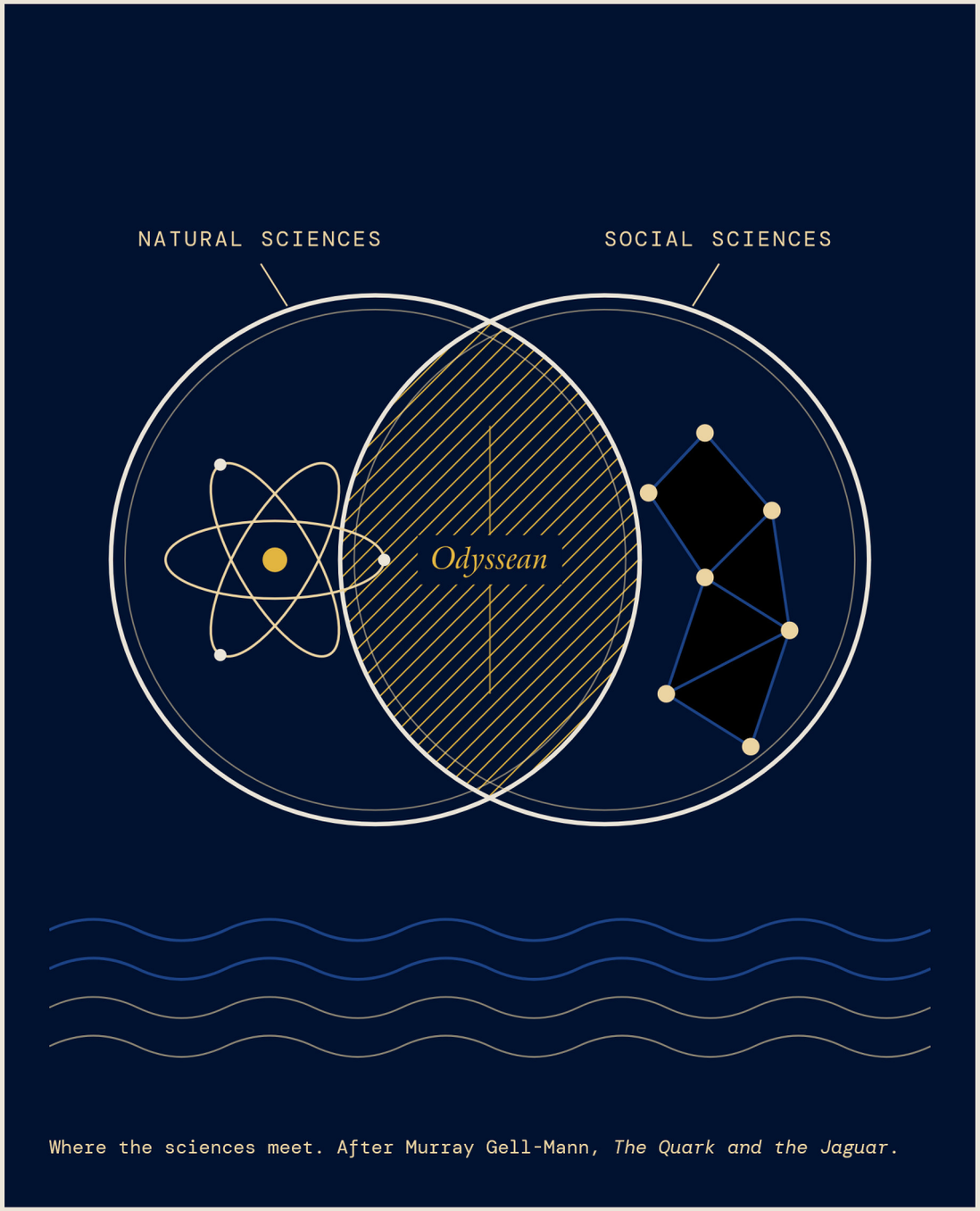
DECISION-MAKING UNDER DEEP UNCERTAINTY

The further we look, *the wider the fan.*

We don't predict one future. We map many, then help people choose policies that hold up across all of them.



ODYSSEAN INSTITUTE



Where the sciences meet. After Murray Gell-Mann, *The Quark and the Jaguar*.

THE ORIGIN OF OUR NAME

Why we are *Odyssean.*

I The education

Nobel laureate Murray Gell-Mann, a founder of the Santa Fe Institute, called for an Odyssean education: one that joins the natural and social sciences, so people can think competently about complex systems.

II The leap

What that education does for one mind, the Odyssean Process does for a whole society. Expert elicitation, exploratory modelling and citizens' assemblies bring scientific rigour and lived experience to the same decision.

III The practice

Today that means a citizens' assembly on AI governance in Manchester, resilient trade mapping through GRAIN, and foresight on the second-order impacts of nuclear risk. One complexity-competent approach, applied to the grand challenges.

Read where the Process, and the name, begin.

The White Paper